Why Your Mind Won't Let You Sleep

Welcome to understanding the mind-sleep connection. I'm David Glenn, a psychiatric nurse practitioner helping people with sleep and anxiety issues.

by Mike Sullivan

Your Brain's Security System

Security System

Brain protects you, not comfort

False Alarms

Triggered by harmless events

Vicious Cycle

Poor sleep makes brain 60% more reactive

Normal vs. Problem Sleep

Normal Sleep Issues

- Can't sleep before big events
- Occasional worry
- Temporary disruption

Problem Sleep

- Can't sleep when actually safe
- Too intense, too frequent
- Avoiding bedtime
- Calculating sleep hours

Sleep Myths Debunked

"Just relax and sleep"

If you could relax, you'd already be sleeping

"Need exactly 8 hours"

Sleep needs vary; obsessing makes it worse

"Good sleepers never wake"

Everyone wakes briefly during night

"Sleep problems = weakness"

40 million adults have sleep issues

Your Path Forward

This Week

Notice your patterns without judgment

Module 1

Understand your specific sleep-anxiety cycle

Module 2-3

Learn and practice techniques that fit your life

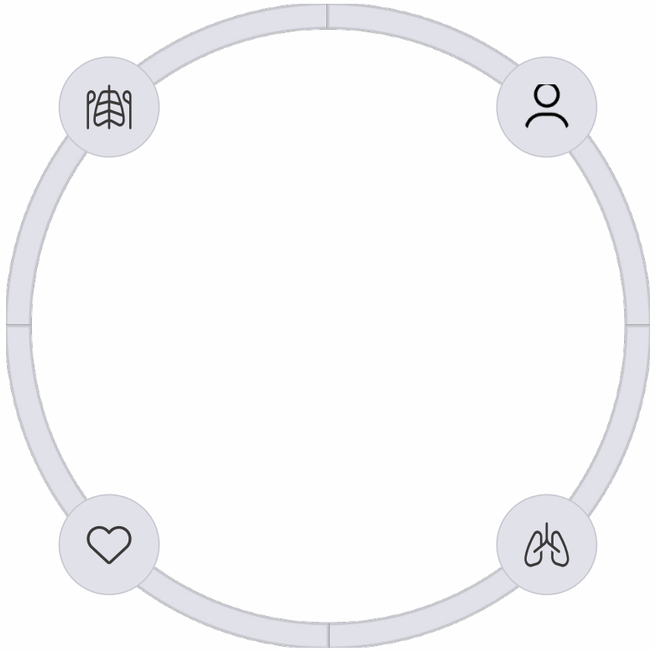
Check Your Body Right Now

Shoulders

Notice any tension or tightness

Jaw

Check if you're clenching



Heart Rate

Notice without trying to change

Breath

Are you holding your breath?

About David Glenn

PMHNP-BC

Board-certified psychiatric nurse practitioner

14 Years Experience

From emergency response to psychiatric crisis units

Founder

Created Real Psychiatric Services as safe space

You're Not Alone

40M

Adults with Sleep Issues

You're part of a common experience

60%

Increased Stress Reactivity

From poor sleep

8-10

Minutes

Time for this introduction